

What to do?

You will work with your group members to prepare a poster in electronic form (I suggest utilizing PowerPoint or Canva) on a sociological issue/problem, its effects on society, your plan to address it locally, and the efforts you went to as a group to execute your plan. Be sure to emphasize why this issue/problem is important in your poster. As a result, there should be six key sections to your poster: 1) Introduction, 2) Background, 3) Argument, 4) Plan, 5) Impact, and 6) References.

Groups will not only go out to work in the community (e.g. addressing the community social problem of “hunger” by conducting a food drive), but the group will also report back on their experiences—i.e. what they did, why they did it, and how it was received—in a short 2-3 page group-written report (due the day of your presentation). You will be expected to include pictures of your work in action in your report, though they won’t be countered towards the page length. Up to 5% extra credit will be available for groups that exceed expectations in how they put their plan into action.

Research Expectations

In preparing your poster, you will need to do some research. You must prepare ASA-style citations and provide PDFs for all information you provide that was either provided or inspired by another source. It will not be sufficient to cite only one source, as that would not meet the expectations of a well-prepared and researched poster. As such, you should utilize no *less than eight* separate sources of information in the construction of this poster. Acceptable sources include (but are not limited to): internet sources/websites, academic journal articles, laws and legislation, and reports. If you have a question about whether a source is acceptable, feel free to reach out to me and ask (e.g. dictionaries, encyclopedias, and our textbook are not acceptable sources). Although Wikipedia is not a reliable source, it is an excellent resource when trying to research a topic (and often points you in the direction of reliable sources you can use for this paper). You can utilize no more than four internet sources/websites. You can, however, reference as many academic journal articles as you would like. I also recommend that you provide statistical graphics, when possible. You can procure these through databanks like the U.S. Census’s [Data Tool](#) and FBI’s [Crime Data Explorer](#)—to just name a couple of options.

Presentation Guidelines

The final version of your poster **must** be approved by the instructor a minimum of one week prior to your presentation. Presentations are to be no less than 5 minutes and no more than 7 minutes in length. You will be treated and graded as professionals for these presentations, so please **come dressed appropriately** (no pajamas). There may also be spontaneous question and answer sessions which may arise, so come to your presentations **prepared**. So, make sure to come prepared to receive and provide questions.

Free Rider Policy

Given the notorious “free-rider” issue that many groups face—where one or more members provide no contribution to the project and leave the work to their colleagues—group members will be required to fill out an evaluation form for their groupmates regarding each individual’s respective contribution. Group members who are determined to have provided no contribution to their group’s project will be assessed a grade of 0% on the project grade. Individuals falling within this determination will have the opportunity to recover a portion of their project grade by completing the assignment on their own.

Graded Elements

- **Project:** Sections (Introduction, Background, Argument, Plan, Impact); Citations/Reference Formatting
- **Presentation:** Presentation Length; Presentation Q&A Preparation
- **Documentation:** PDFs provided, Citations, and Citation/Reference Formatting
- **Group Report:** Sections (What did you do, why did you do it, what was the impact); Length